SPRING CLEANING FREE PACK · SHEET 3 OF 7

Declutter Decision Card

For the item in your hand that refuses to be easy. Tapes onto a cupboard door.

1. **What is it?** Say it plainly: “This is a ” If you can't finish the sentence, that is information. “A thing I forgot I owned” is a real answer.

2. **Have I used it in the last 12 months?** Yes → keep. No → keep going. Six-month not-12 works for seasonal gear too.

3. **Would I buy it again today, at full price?** The honest question. A “eh…” is a “probably not”.

4. **If I needed it, would it be easy to replace?** Cheap, common, or borrowable → let it go. Hard to replace and wanted → congratulations, you found a keeper.

5. **Am I keeping it out of guilt, not love?** Gifts you don't use, hobbies that aren't happening this year, clothes from a body you had 10 years and 2 kids ago. Guilt is a poor storage strategy — the space costs more than the sentiment.

6. **Is it someone else's definition of useful?** “But it's perfectly good!” Perfectly good things belong with perfectly thrilled people. Someone freecycling or heading to donate would love it.

7. **The one-memory test:** take a photo. If the memory lives in the photo as well as it does in the box, the photo is enough. Keep the photo; let the object travel.

8. **If I died today, could someone decide what this is?** Hard to face, so keep it gentle: labeling makes life easy for the people who tidy up after us. Basics in labeled bins; a short note on anything precious.

9. **Sell, donate, or bin?**

Final stop: the three-way

Sell, if it's...

- Worth the trouble of listing (> ~$30)
- Complete, clean, working
- Easy to describe and ship

Set a sale deadline — if it hasn't sold in a set number of days it goes straight to donate. A sold-then-donated item is a success either way.

Donate / give, if it's...

- Useful and clean
- Too cheap to bother selling
- Gone within a month of “I'll sell it later”

Log every drop on the Freecycle & Donate Drop Log — the log is what makes giving feel like a win.

The three kinds of “maybe” bins

Maybe-bay A (3 months): truly uncertain. Date it. **Maybe-bay B (1 week):** practically certain — just wanted a safety net. **The box of no (1 day):** decisions you've already made once and don't want to re-litigate. Anything in the box after one day goes out the door untouched, no exceptions — it's the only way the box ever stays honest.

Fast exit ladder (use when stuck with 15 things — 15 decisions, not 30 minutes of agonizing)

- [ ] Broken? Bin/repair, done deciding
- [ ] Duplicate? Extras out immediately
- [ ] Expired? Gone before you think twice
- [ ] Flat-out crack? Out
- [ ] Never-installed, never-started? Out
- [ ] Someday-someday? Out today or never
- [ ] Story is “might use”? Maybe-bay, dated
- [ ] Story is “I love it”? Keep, no guilt
- [ ] Sentimental heavy? Photo + keep one
- [ ] Brand-new never-used? Regift or donate
- [ ] Was it out during tidy-up? Rehome
- [ ] $1 or less of consequence? Gone
- [ ] Can't afford to re-buy? Keep guilt-free
- [ ] Heavy hard-to-replace for one? Keep
- [ ] Still stuck after all this? Maybe-bay A, for three months

A kind word about guilt

Nobody declutters with love. Everybody declutters with mission. The moment you're picturing the room instead of the item is the moment the decision gets easy. The card is not trying to talk you out of loving things — it's trying to stop guilt from renting shelf space. If you keep it and it makes you smile every time you pass, that's a win, not a fail. If it lives in a box you don't open for 3 years, it was never love — and it's ready to become someone else's favorite thing.

Space it takes up physically = the real price tag

Every square inch you storing costs you every single day. Keeping a thing costs: dust, care, schedule, decision-fatigue, mental load, physical space. Keeping a thing is never free. So ask not “is it worthless?” but **“what does it cost me to keep it?”** — and that question always has a number, even if the number is zero.

Keep this card where clutter happens. Print one per household member if each of you is going to face your own drawer demons — gamely and without judgment.